CSV/Excel VLOOKUP Append Tool

Complete User Guide

What This Tool Does

This tool performs a VLOOKUP-style merge between two files. It takes a MAIN FILE containing your primary dataset (with potentially hundreds of records) and an APPEND FILE with additional fields to add. The tool matches records based on a common identifier called "siteacronym" and appends new columns to all matching rows.

Real-World Example

Imagine you have a file with 500 invoice records across 14 different client sites. You want to add 5 new data fields (like contact info, billing codes, etc.) to each record based on which site it belongs to. Instead of manually entering this information 500 times, you create a simple file with 14 rows (one per site) containing the 5 fields. This tool automatically adds those fields to all 500 records based on matching site identifiers.

How It Works (Technical Overview)

1. Tool reads main file and identifies unique siteacronym values
2. Reads append file (one row per siteacronym with new fields)
3. For each row in main file, looks up matching siteacronym
4. Copies append field values to the main file row
5. All rows with same siteacronym get same appended data

Key Features

- Supports CSV and Excel files (.csv, .xlsx, .xls)
- Handles multiple records per siteacronym
- Automatically trims whitespace from all values
- Runs entirely in browser (no server uploads)
- Privacy-compliant and secure
- Preview data before merging

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1: Upload Main File

1. Click "Select your main CSV or Excel file"
2. Choose your file containing the primary dataset
3. File must have column headers in the first row
4. Preview of first 100 rows displays below
5. Success message shows row and column count

Step 2: Select Lookup Column

1. Dropdown menu shows all column names
2. Select which column contains siteacronym values
3. Tool auto-selects "siteacronym" or "acronym" if found
4. Displays count of unique siteacronym values
5. This column is the matching key for the merge

Step 3: Upload Append Data File

1. Click "Select append data CSV or Excel file"
2. Choose file with additional fields to append
3. File MUST have "siteacronym" or "acronym" column
4. Typically one row per unique siteacronym
5. Preview shows the append data structure
6. Siteacronym column highlighted in gray

Step 4: Execute VLOOKUP & Merge

1. Click "Execute VLOOKUP & Merge" button
2. Tool matches rows based on siteacronym
3. Appends new fields to all matching rows
4. Success message shows match statistics
5. Preview of merged data displays below

Step 5: Download Merged Result

1. Click "Download Merged CSV" button
2. File automatically downloads as "merged_data.csv"
3. Contains all original columns plus new fields
4. Ready to open in Excel or other applications

File Requirements & Format

Main File Requirements:

- Format: CSV (.csv), Excel (.xlsx or .xls)
- Must have header row with column names
- Must have at least one data row
- Must contain a column with siteacronym values
- Can have duplicate siteacronym values (multiple rows)
- Example: 500 rows with 14 different siteacronyms

Append File Requirements:

- Format: CSV (.csv), Excel (.xlsx or .xls)
- Must have header row with column names
- MUST have column named "siteacronym" or "acronym"
- Typically one row per unique siteacronym
- Contains the new fields to append
- Example: 14 rows with 5 additional fields each

Complete Example Scenario

Main File: Contains 500 invoice records with columns: Invoice_ID, Date, Amount, Client_Site. The Client_Site column has 14 different values (ABC, XYZ, etc.) repeated throughout the 500 rows.

Append File: Contains 14 rows (one per site) with columns: siteacronym, Contact_Name, Contact_Email, Billing_Code, Region, Tax_Rate.

Result: 500 rows with all original columns PLUS the 5 new fields. Each invoice automatically receives the correct contact info and billing details based on its Client_Site value.

Troubleshooting Common Issues

Issue: "File must have siteacronym column"

Solution: Your append file needs a column named exactly "siteacronym" or "acronym". Check spelling and capitalization.

Issue: "No rows matched"

Solution: The siteacronym values in your two files don't match. Check for typos, extra spaces, or different capitalization. The tool automatically trims spaces but values must match exactly otherwise.

Issue: "Invalid file format"

Solution: Only CSV and Excel formats are supported. Save your file as .csv, .xlsx, or .xls. Ensure the file has headers in the first row.

Privacy & Security Information

This tool processes all data entirely within your web browser. No files are uploaded to external servers or cloud services. All processing happens locally on your device. Your data remains completely private and secure. When you close the browser, all data is cleared from memory.